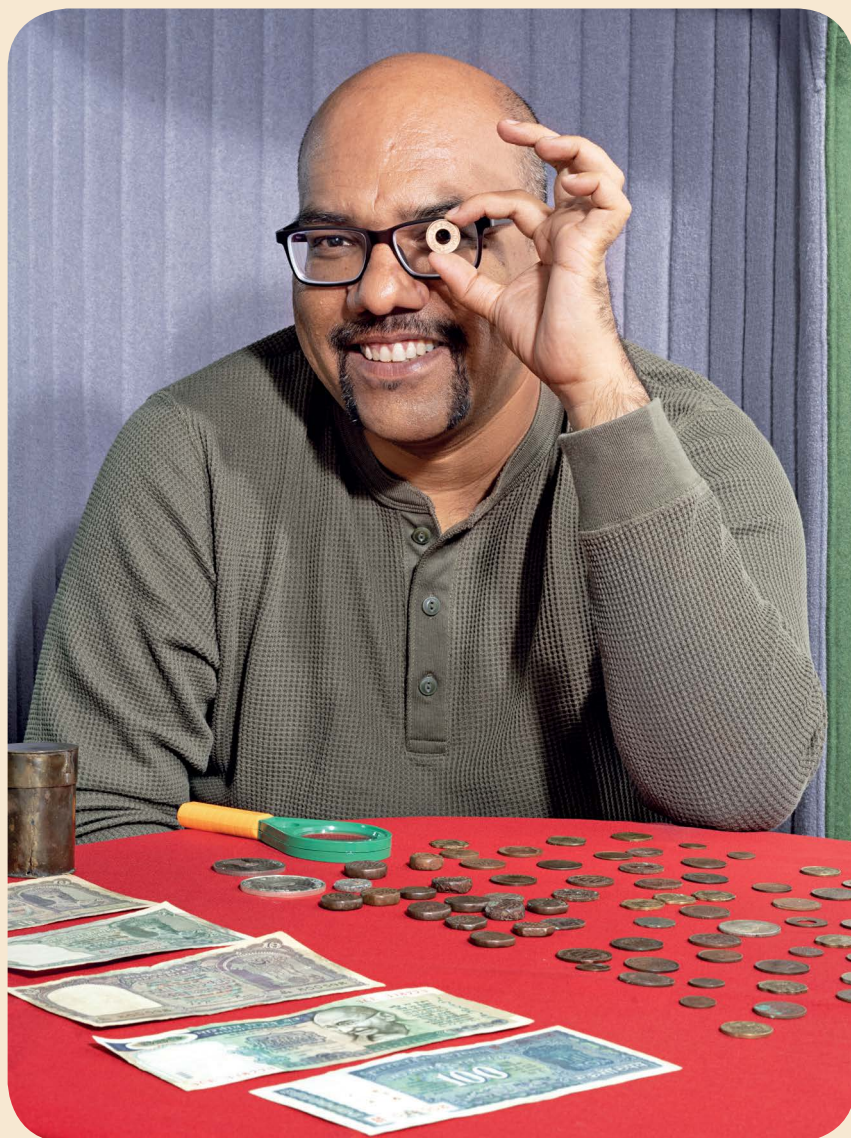




MORE THAN MONEY Aloke Bajpai was introduced to coin collecting by his grandfather when he was a child

THE COIN COLLECTOR

Aloke Bajpai, Co-founder and Group CEO of ixigo, has more than 700 coins, some dating back to the Mughal era

BY SMITA TRIPATHI

PHOTO BY HARDIK CHHABRA

W

WHEN ALOKE BAJPAI, Co-founder and Group CEO of on-line travel aggregator platform ixigo, was around 10 years old, his grandfather gave him some British era coins. The young boy was fascinated and that started his love affair with coin collecting.

Over the years, Bajpai has collected coins from the Mughal empire and also the Maratha period. "Some of

"I also have coins from the British era. I have coins released during the reign of Queen Victoria, King George V and King George VI. I also have bank notes from the time of George VI"

these coins I found in a family chest. Some others were exchanged with other coin collectors," says the 43-year-old. He also has old copper *mohars* that are undated.

Bajpai enjoys collecting coins that were released to mark special occasions such as 50 years of Indian independence or the Commonwealth Games. "These days the commemorative coins have become more rare. So if I get my hands on one, I keep it."

The ixigo Co-founder adds he also has coins from the British era. "I have coins released during the reign of Queen